

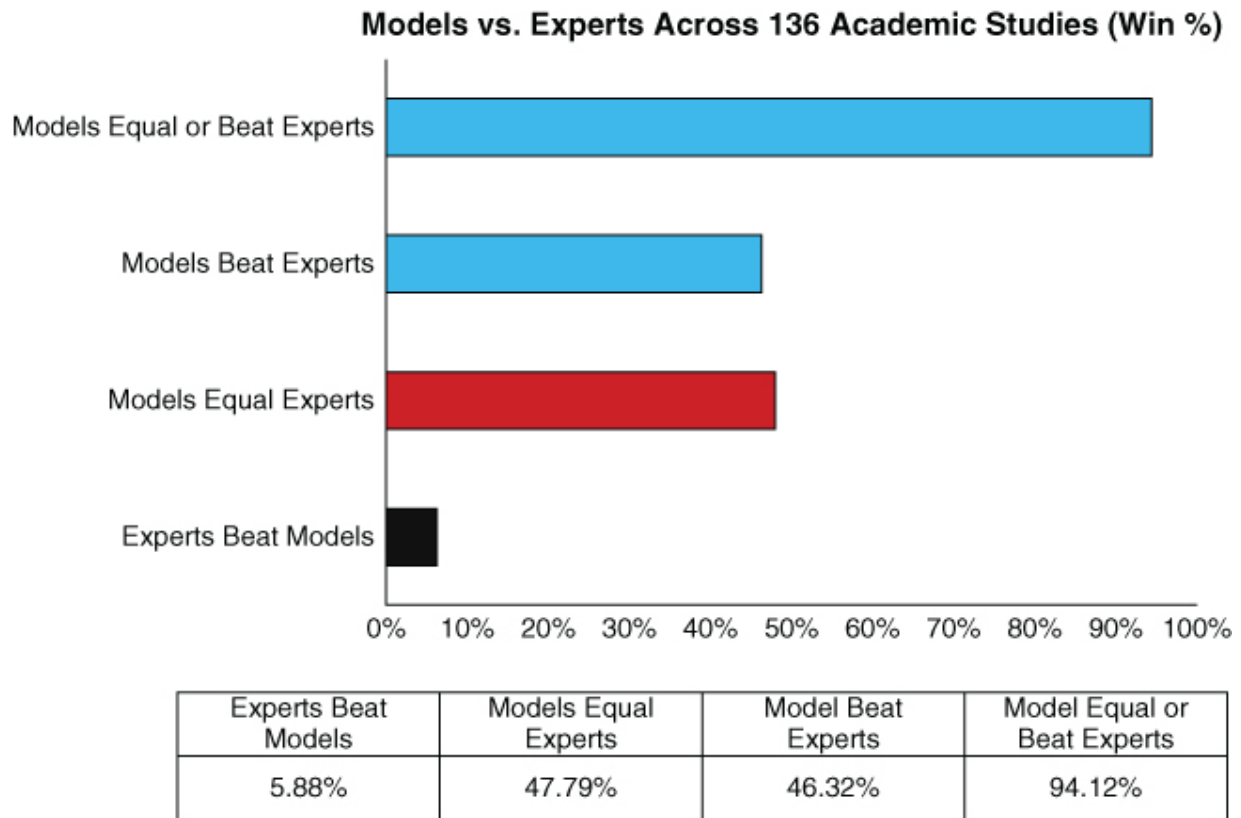


Figure 2.2 Models vs. Experts Across 136 Academic Studies (Win %)

The empirical evidence on the horse race between model-driven decisions and discretionary decision-making is clear, maybe even a slam dunk, but the implications are unsettling. How is it possible that a simple algorithm can consistently beat expert opinion? The answer to this conundrum lies with cognitive bias, which we will return to in a moment. But first, let's consider an important question that naturally relates to these results.

What if Experts Have the Model?

Although evidence clearly suggests that models meet—and often beat—experts across a variety of contexts, scholars were also inspired to tackle another question: *How do experts perform if they are given the results of the model?*

Dano Leli and Susan Filskov explore this question in their 1984 study, “Clinical Detection of Intellectual Deterioration Associated with Brain Damage.” The study's premise is simple, and begins in the traditional way, by pitting models against experts. First, place experienced psychologists